

MASK SLIP

A Feature Screenplay — Elevated Thriller / Horror

Story & Screenplay by Zoe Miller | Based on her original song "The Mask" [zoemcreative \(YouTube\)](#)

When her estranged younger sister vanishes into an upstate wellness retreat, a sound healer who spent four years surviving a narcissist of her own goes undercover inside the compound — and has to decide whether the charismatic founder's hold over dozens of followers is a supernatural hunger passed down four generations, or simply the most ordinary evil this country produces, dressed in incense and good lighting, before her sister becomes its next "Primary Supply."

THE HOOK

MASK SLIP uses the machinery of horror — a gated compound, masked rituals, a possibly-supernatural entity — to literalize the real psychology of narcissistic abuse: DARVO, love-bombing into isolation, and "flying monkeys," the weaponized kindness of a community that surrounds a target with warmth until compliance looks like healing. It subverts genre expectation at the climax: the protagonist doesn't defeat the entity with force, she alchemizes rather than destroys, refusing to feed it fear, shame, or an audience — and the film never confirms whether what she faced was literal or psychological. That ambiguity is load-bearing, not a loose end.

SYNOPSIS

WREN MERCER, a sound healer, gets a frightened voicemail from her sister IVY, newly devoted to the Aurelia Circle, a retreat run by magnetic RAFFA AURELIO and his wife SELAH. Inside, Wren finds a community that is genuinely both real healing and real predation, running on the same machinery — and uncovers a ledger tracking members as "Supply" going back to 1911, with Ivy's initial already penciled in as next. Her confrontation with Rafe isn't a fight; it's a refusal to perform fear or shame for a room built to feed on both — and whatever leaves him doesn't leave because he earned it. It simply has nothing left to eat, and goes looking for a fuller room.

KEY CHARACTERS

WREN MERCER — sound healer; a Derek-survivor whose arc is learning that refusing to perform for an audience is its own power.

IVY MERCER — Wren's sister, groomed as the next "Primary Supply." **RAFFA AURELIO** — grandiose founder, possibly a vessel for something four generations old; the film never says which. **SELAH AURELIO** — covert co-founder, unnervingly self-aware.

NAN CASSIDY — Wren's mentor, lost her own daughter to the organization's earlier form in 1994.

COMPARABLE TITLES

Pan's Labyrinth's dark-fairytale ambiguity, *Hereditary's* refusal to resolve entity-or-psychology, *The Invitation's* slow-burn infiltration dread, *Martha Marcy May Marlene's* grounded cult psychology, with the communal dread of *Midsommar* and the restraint of *Sound of My Voice*.

Zoe Miller is a screenwriter and songwriter with scripts listed on The Black List. MASK SLIP is adapted from her original song of the same thematic DNA, which she owns outright — a real packaging asset for trailer and marketing use. The Aurelia Circle is one of at least nine "sister circles" established on the page, built to anchor a franchise slate beyond a single feature.

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